AI Hackathon Judging Rubric

Total Score: **100 Points**

4.1 Business Problem Clarity (5 Points)

Measures whether the team clearly identified a **real business problem**.

Sub-Criteria	Score	What Judges Look For
4.1.1 Problem Definition	0 – 2	Clear explanation of the current challenge
4.1.2 Stakeholder Identification	0 - 1	Who experiences the problem
4.1.3 Business Context	0 – 1	Why solving this matters
4.1.4 Measurable Outcome	0 – 1	Quantifiable success metric

Score Interpretation

Score	Meaning
0-1	Problem unclear or poorly defined
2-3	Problem defined but limited business context. Basic understanding
4-5	Clear, meaningful business problem with measurable impact

Example strong statement:
"Customer support agents spend 35% of their time manually searching documentation."

"Fraud analysts manually review nearly **12,000 transactions per day**, yet less than **2% are actually fraudulent**, causing significant investigation overhead."

"Engineering teams spend **20–30 minutes diagnosing each API outage** by manually reviewing logs, delaying incident resolution."

"Customer support agents must navigate **4–6 internal systems** to understand a customer's history, increasing average handling time."

"Customers abandon account opening forms because the **process is complex and unclear**, leading to lost conversions."

Example average statement

"New employees spend excessive time searching for internal information rather than executing tasks."

"Document verification requires human validation of multiple fields, increasing operational overhead."

Example bad statement

"Fraud detection could be improved with AI."

"Customer support agents need better tools."

4.2 AI Innovation (15 Points)
Evaluates creativity and sophistication of AI usage.

Sub-Criteria	Score	What Judges Look For
4.2.1 Novelty of Idea	0-4	Is this a new way to solve the problem
4.2.2 Use of AI Techniques	0-4	LLMs, RAG, ML, Agents, Vision etc.
4.2.3 AI Appropriateness	0-3	AI actually needed vs automation
4.2.4 Technical Creativity	0-4	Combining models, pipelines, workflows

Innovation Levels

Score	Meaning
0-2	Simple automation
3-6	Standard AI Use
7-10	Creative AI application
11-15	Highly innovative AI solution

Example high innovation:

- Multi-agent AI system
- AI + knowledge graph
- AI workflow automation across systems

4.3 Technical Implementation (15 Points)
Evaluates **how well the solution was built.**

Sub-Criteria	Score	What Judges Look For
4.3.1 Prototype Functionality	0-5	Working demo
4.3.2 Architecture Design	0-3	Clean technical architecture
4.3.3 AI Model Implementation	0-4	Model integration quality
4.3.4 Code Quality / Engineering	0-3	Structured implementation

Score Meaning

Score	Interpretation
0-5	Concept Only
6-10	Partial prototype
11-15	Functional Working system

4.4 Business Impact (20 Points)
Evaluates **value creation for the organization**.

Sub-Criteria	Score	Evaluation Focus
4.4.1 Cost Savings Potential	0-5	Operational efficiency
4.4.2 Revenue Impact	0-5	New revenue opportunities
4.4.3 Productivity Improvement	0-5	Time saved
4.4.4 Customer Value	0-5	Customer experience improvement

Impact Scale

Score	Meaning
0-5	Small improvement
6-10	Department impact
11-15	Multi-team impact
16-20	Enterprise-wide value

Example

Impact	Example
Low	Saves a few hours weekly
Medium	Automates a process
High	Creates a new product

4.5 UI/UX Quality (10 Points)

UI/UX Quality means whether the team has designed a **clear user experience that makes the AI solution easy to interact with and understand.**

Sub-Criteria	Score	Evaluation Focus
4.5.1 Interface Clarity	0-2	Interface is intuitive and easy to understand
4.5.2 User Workflow Design	0-2	Integration with systems
4.5.3 Visual Design & Layout	0-2	Clean layout, readability, logical information structure
4.5.4 AI Transparency	0-1	AI outputs are explainable and understandable
4.5.5 Accessibility & Usability	0-1	Easy for non-technical users to interact with
4.5.6 Interaction Quality	0-2	Smooth interaction with the AI system (inputs, responses, feedback)

Scoring Criteria

Score	Meaning
0-3	UI/UX unclear or missing. Prototype difficult to understand or navigate.
4-7	Basic interface exists but usability could be improved. Limited consideration of user workflow.
8-10	Clear, intuitive, and well-designed interface that demonstrates strong user-centered thinking.

4.6 Feasibility & Scalability (5 Points)

Can the idea actually be deployed in production?

Sub-Criteria	Score	Evaluation Focus
4.6.1 Data Availability	0-1	Data exists and accessible
4.6.2 Integration Complexity	0-2	Integration with systems
4.6.3 Security & Compliance	0-1	Governance considerations
4.6.4 Operational Scalability	0-1	Can scale enterprise-wide

Feasibility Levels

Score	Meaning
0-1	Unrealistic
2-3	Achievable with effort
4-5	Production-ready concept

4.7 Collaboration Score (15 Points)

Measures **team collaboration and diversity of expertise**

Sub-Criteria	Score	Evaluation Focus
4.7.1 Cross-Functional Representation	0-4	Business + technical roles
4.7.2 Participation Balance	0-4	Multiple team members contributed
4.7.3 Integration of Skills	0-3	Business + tech combined
4.7.4 Team Execution	0-4	Evidence of teamwork

4.8 Presentation & Storytelling (15 Points)

Sub-Criteria	Score	Evaluation Focus
4.8.1 Problem Explanation	0-3	Clear articulation
4.8.2 Solution Clarity	0-3	Easy to understand
4.8.3 Demo Quality	0-4	Demo effectiveness
4.8.4 Storytelling	0-5	Logical narrative

Score Meaning

Score	Meaning
0-5	Poor explanation
6-10	Clear presentation
11-15	Compelling narrative